

Question 12 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

State any two ways in which HRD and HRM are related.

Introduction

Human Resource Management (HRM) and Human Resource Development (HRD) confuse many students because both deal with people. They are related, but they are not the same word. For 8 marks you must state two clear relationships, explain them with examples, and then briefly show differences so that the examiner knows you are not mixing the terms.

HRM is the broader management of people: getting them (recruitment), paying them, looking after law and welfare, using them on jobs, and also developing them. HRD is the specialised, planned process of developing capabilities, potential and culture. Think of HRM as the whole house and HRD as the part of the house where people grow. A house without that room still stands for a while, but it does not improve.

Detailed points

1. First relationship — HRD is the developmental core inside HRM. HRM, in the notes, deals with procurement, development, compensation, maintenance and utilisation of human resources. HRD deals with bringing desired changes in behaviour and with efficient utilisation through growth; it is described as a part of HRM. So the first relationship is whole-and-part. Every complete HRM function must contain HRD. If a company only hires and pays people and never develops them, it is doing incomplete HRM. Example: a factory recruits 50 operators (HRM procurement) and pays wages (HRM compensation). HRD then inducts them, trains them on safety and machines, and later prepares some of them to become supervisors. Without HRD, the 50 operators remain at joining-day skill forever.

2. Why this relationship matters. If students treat HRD as a totally separate subject, they cannot explain why appraisal files, manpower plans and promotion policies sit in the HR department and still feed training. The relationship is practical: HRM systems produce data; HRD uses that data to develop people. Selection quality and development quality together produce performance.

3. Second relationship — they complement each other's aims. HRM is largely maintenance-oriented: keep the organisation staffed, legally safe, paid and reasonably stable. HRD is development-oriented: change behaviour, raise competence, build climate. These aims need each other. Fair pay, job security and clear contracts (HRM) make employees mentally ready to learn. Learning, coaching and career growth (HRD) make the payroll productive. Example: if wages are unpaid, nobody will attend a leadership workshop with a sincere mind. If wages are paid but nobody is trained on a new machine, the wage bill produces scrap. That is complementarity.

4. Shared people, shared line managers, shared strategy. A third way they are related (you should add this after the two main ones) is that both succeed only when line managers cooperate. The HR manager cannot develop a salesperson sitting in another city; the sales boss must coach. Modern strategic HRM says people are a competitive resource; that strategy is actually delivered through HRD (competencies, learning, leadership pipeline). So HRD is how strategic HRM becomes real.

5. Information relationship. Appraisal reports, transfer orders, absenteeism data and manpower forecasts belong to HRM administration. HRD needs them for TNA, succession and counselling. If the two do not share information, development is blind.

6. Differences that still prove they are related (not identical). HRM structure is often an independent personnel department; HRD needs interdependent structures across departments. HRM responsibility is often the personnel manager's; HRD responsibility is every manager's. HRM often motivates with money; HRD motivates through higher-order needs (achievement, recognition, growth). Write these as a small contrast after the two relationships so you do not lose marks for 'mixing HRM and HRD'.

7. Worked example that shows both relations together. A hospital hires nurses (HRM), follows labour law and pays them (HRM), runs duty rosters (HRM utilisation). HRD runs induction, clinical skill training, counselling after night-shift stress, and career paths to sister-in-charge. If HRM hiring is careless, HRD cannot magically create skill. If HRD is absent, even well-paid nurses leave or stagnate. Relation is two-way dependence.

8. Exam presentation. Introduction: define both in two sentences. Point 1: HRD as developmental part of HRM, with example. Point 2: complementary maintenance vs development. Then a short paragraph of other links (data, line managers, strategy) and a 5-line difference box in words. Conclusion: interdependent, not identical.

Conclusion. *Two clear relationships: (1) HRD is the development function within the broader HRM umbrella; (2) HRM's maintenance conditions and HRD's growth processes complement each other and share data, managers and strategy. Do not write only differences, and do not write that the two words mean the same thing.*